

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 7 5 4 3

♥ Q 10 3

♦ A 4

♣ J 10 3

♠ A 10 2

♥ A J 7

♦ J 8 6 2

♣ K 6 5



♠ J 6

♥ 9 8 5 2

♦ 9 7 5

♣ A Q 9 8

♠ K Q 9

♥ K 6 4

♦ K Q 10 3

♣ 7 4 2

West	North	East	South
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Pass	2NT	Pass	1♦
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All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♥9
done on his own.

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 3NT

Lead the ♥9, the top of nothing.

Your ♣s are so good that all your instincts tell you to lead the ♣8, and perhaps set up 3 winners.

If you had one more small ♣s your instincts would be right, but with only a 4-card suit you should think a little longer. Three tricks won't set this contract, so you must depend on partner winning something. And if partner is going to win something perhaps he will lead a ♣ and you might make FOUR tricks in the suit.

So lead the ♥9. You lead a high card so partner won't be tempted to return the suit when he gets the lead. Note that although this lead finesses partner's ♥Q, it didn't do anything that declarer wouldn't have

Declarer must play ♦s to get some winners, and when West takes the ♦A he will surely switch to the ♣J. Down goes declarer.

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 10 8

♥ 7

♦ A 7 5 3 2

♣ 8 5 3 2

♠ 5

♥ K Q 9 6 3

♦ K 6

♣ K Q 10 9 6



♠ Q J 9 7 6 2

♥ A 8 5 4

♦ 4

♣ 7 4

♠ A 4 3

♥ J 10 2

♦ Q J 10 9 8

♣ A J

West	North	East	South
	1 ♥	2 ♠	3 ♦
3 ♠	4 ♣	Pass	4 ♥
Pass	Pass	4 ♠	Dbl
All Pass			

4 ♠ X by East

Lead: ♠ A

left with two losing ♥s and will be down 2. Without the two trump plays he could have ruffed all three of his ♥ losers and actually made the contract.

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 4 ♠ doubled

Lead the ♠ A.

East's 2 ♠ bid is a Weak-jump Overcall, based on a 6-card ♠ suit and a weak hand.

Either the ♦ Q or ♥ J would normally be good leads.

But on this deal West/East have clearly sacrificed against your almost certain ♥ game. Since they don't have enough high-card strength to make this contract declarer is hoping to get some ruffs.

The way to cut down the number of ruffs he can make is to lead a trump at every opportunity.

So take the ♠ A and then play another ♠. Declarer will still be able to ruff one ♥ in dummy, but will be

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 8 7 3
 ♥ Q 10 7 3
 ♦ 7 5
 ♣ 6 3 2

♠ 10 6 4

♥ 6 4 2

♦ K 9 4 2

♣ A K J



♠ Q 9 2

♥ K 8 5

♦ A 8 6

♣ 10 9 7 5

♠ A J 5

♥ A J 9

♦ Q J 10 3

♣ Q 8 4

West

North

East

South

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♥3

1NT

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 3NT

Lead the ♥3, fourth highest in an attacking suit.

Sometimes it comes down to just this kind of choice. Do you lead fourth down from ♠ K 8 7 3 or from ♥ Q 10 7 3.

The presence of the ♥10 bolsters the ♥ suit enough to give it the edge.

The suits could be arranged something like shown at left. With a ♠ lead the presence of the ♠10 in dummy allows declarer to make a second ♠ trick, which happens to be declarer's ninth trick.

But when you lead the ♥3 it does not promote a ♥ winner for declarer, and left to his own devices, he cannot establish the ♠ winner.

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ K Q J 9 5 4

♥ A J 10

♦ 6

♣ A 5 2

♠ 6 3

♥ K 6 3

♦ A 7 4

♣ 10 9 8 7 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 10

♥ 9 4

♦ K Q J 9 8 3

♣ K Q J

♠ 8 7 2

♥ Q 8 7 5 2

♦ 10 5 2

♣ 6 3

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♦ Pass

1 ♠ Pass

3 ♠ Pass

4NT Pass

6 ♠

All Pass

6 ♠ by West

Lead: ♥ 3

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 6 ♠

Lead the ♥ 3.

The ♣ 10 would probably be a very safe lead. But you don't want "safe", you want "attack".

Dummy has advertised a long, strong ♦ suit which declarer will no doubt establish for discards.

It is important for your side to create a winner before your ♦ A is forced out. The most likely looking winner is your ♥ K. So lead the small ♥ and hope partner has the Queen.

Board 5

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K Q J 10 8

♥ 7 5 2

♦ A 5

♣ 9 6 3

♠ 5 3

♥ K Q J

♦ Q J 10 9 7

♣ A 10 4



♠ 4

♥ 10 9 8 4

♦ 8 6 3 2

♣ K 8 7 2

♠ A 9 7 6 2

♥ A 6 3

♦ K 4

♣ Q J 5

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

Dbl

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♠ 4

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 3NT

Lead the ♠ 4.

If partner had not doubled the contract you would probably have started with the ♥ 10, or possibly the ♣ 2.

But partner DID double, and most good players play that doubling 3NT is lead-directing as follows: If you have bid a suit, lead it. If doubler has bid a suit, lead it. If neither of you has bid, lead dummy's first bid suit.

So lead a ♠, certainly not a lead you would have made without the double. Partner immediately establishes 4 ♠ winners and he has the ♦ A for an entry.

With any other lead declarer will make the contract.

Board 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

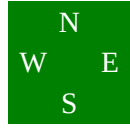
♠ A 8 6 4
 ♥ A J 6 5
 ♦ Q 7
 ♣ J 6 3

♠ 5 2

♥ Q 7 3

♦ 8 4 2

♣ A K Q 7 4



♠ K Q 7

♥ K 10 9 8

♦ A K 5

♣ 10 9 2

♠ J 10 9 3

♥ 4 2

♦ J 10 9 6 3

♣ 8 5

West

North

East

South

2♣

Dbl

2♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by East

Lead: ♣8

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 4♥

Lead the ♣8.

If partner had not doubled West's Stayman 2♣ bid you would probably have started with one of your Jacks.

But partner **DID** double, and the double of a conventional bid clearly means that the doubler would like you to lead that suit.

So lead a ♣, and partner will take three ♣ tricks. With any other lead declarer would quickly discard a ♣ from dummy on a high ♦, easily making the contract.

Declarer may still make the contract if he guesses the ♥Q correctly, but maybe not.